Martha Upton

June 1, 2021

Opposition to
Case 19-G-0309 – Proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to the Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of The Brooklyn Union Gas Company d/b/a National Grid NY for Gas Service Case
19-G-0310 – Proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to the Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of KeySpan Gas East Corporation d/b/a National Grid for Gas Service

I have lived in the New York City area for my entire adult life. I spent my career working with young children, both as a teacher and as an elementary school administrator. One of the most difficult, painful aspects of teaching children in the 21st century is that they absolutely need to learn about the precarious and fragile state of the planet they are about to inherit. When you work with children, there is no place to hide. Their questions are urgent, demanding, and relentless. I believe that adults have a profound responsibility to do whatever it takes to turn the climate crisis around and put us all on the road to a sustainable future. Every decision we make at this point has to be made with this imperative in mind.

The proposed pipeline does the opposite of helping move us forward into a sustainable future. It doubles down on past mistakes, keeps us mired in a destructive dependence on fossil fuels and the infrastructure they require, and denies New York citizens the path to a healthy environment, which is our right. We no longer have the luxury of postponing the crucial work of moving away from oil and gas as energy sources. I oppose the joint proposal because it is retrograde, short-sighted, and destructive.

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